F Mich 1 Grammar notes

How to ask closed questions in French

- Statements usually follow the order SUBJECT-VERB-OBJECT
  - *Vous aimez le français*
  - *Il aime l'école*
- Closed (yes or no) questions can be asked in one of three ways
  1. Add a **question mark** to the statement (+ raise your voice when speaking)
     - *Vous aimez le français?*
     - *Il aime l'école?*
  2. Put "**est-ce que**" at the beginning of the statement
     - *Est-ce que vous aimez le français?*
     - *Est-ce qu'il aime l'école?*
  3. By **inversion** (switching) of the SUBJECT and the VERB
     - *Aimez-vous le français?*
     - *Aime-t-il le français?* **(the "t" is meaningless but necessary**: it is always added when a verb ending in a vowel is joined to "il/elle/on")

     * **If you want to "invert" someone's name, you use the name first, and then invert the verb and the subject pronoun.**
     - *Jérome fait les courses.*
     - *Jérome fait-il les courses?*

When to use the Present Tense

- The present tense is used to describe:
  - **What you are doing** *(I am eating)*
  - **What you normally do** *(I eat)*
  - **What you have been doing/have done for some time**
    (I have been eating for…. I have eaten for…)

- Only the context tells you whether *je mange* means *I eat* or *I am eating*. **Never attempt to say anything like** ~~*je suis mangeant*~~.

Je lis cette page	*Je suis à Eton College*	*Nous écoutons le professeur*
Elle aime le chocolat	*Ils jouent au foot le soir*	*Je me couche à 10 heures*
J'habite à Londres depuis 5 ans	*Je suis ici depuis une semaine*	

Forming the Present Tense of regular ER verbs

- To form the present tense of regular ER verbs, simply:
  - **Remove the infinitive ending** ER (mang~~er~~, regard~~er~~, parl~~er~~)
  - You are left with the "stem". **Add the personal ending to the stem**
    1. je PARL – **e**
    2. tu PARL – **es**
    3. il/elle PARL – **e**
    4. nous PARL – **ons**
    5. vous PARL – **ez**
    6. ils PARL – **ent**

- Some other **very** common verbs which follow this pattern are:

chercher	*to look for*	**décider**	*to decide*
demander	*to ask for*	**détester**	*to hate*
discuter	*to discuss*	**donner**	*to give*
fermer	*to close*	**gagner**	*to earn/win*
jouer	*to play*	**laisser**	*to leave/let*
louer	*to hire/rent*	**marcher**	*to walk/work*
parler	*to speak*	**penser**	*to think*
porter	*to wear/carry*	**préparer**	*to prepare*
regarder	*to watch/look at*	**téléphoner**	*to phone*
toucher	*to touch*	**travailler**	*to work*
trouver	*to find*	**visiter**	*to visit*

Three common irregular verbs

- These verbs need to be learned off by heart in all persons.

AVOIR	*to have*	**ÊTRE**	*to be*	**ALLER**	*to go*
j'	**ai**	je	**suis**	je	**vais**
tu	**as**	tu	**es**	tu	**vas**
il/elle	**a**	il/elle	**est**	il/elle	**va**
nous	**avons**	nous	**sommes**	nous	**allons**
vous	**avez**	vous	**êtes**	vous	**allez**
ils/elles	**ont**	ils/elles	**sont**	ils/elles	**vont**